

A:1

Theme

from Theme and Variations, Sonatina No. 4 in D

Thomas Attwood
(1765-1838)

Andante [$\text{♩} = \text{c.}108$]

Thomas Attwood was an English composer and organist who sang in the choir of the Chapel Royal from the age of nine. He studied in Naples and then with Mozart in Vienna (1785-7). After his return to England, he became music tutor to the royal family and later organist of St Paul's Cathedral, London, and composer to the Chapel Royal.

This piece is the theme from Attwood's Theme and Variations, and it illustrates his melodious style, which often seems to owe much to Mozart. When he was studying in Vienna, Mozart said of him: 'He partakes more of my style than any scholar I ever had; and I predict that he will prove a sound musician.'

Source: *Easy Progressive Lessons fingered for Young Beginners on the Piano Forte or Harpsichord* (London, c.1795). The tempo mark is editorial. In the original, b. 24 is identical to b. 8 (the bass quavers lead into the first variation). All dynamics and slurs are editorial suggestions only.

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Adapted from Attwood: *Easy Progressive Lessons*, edited by Richard Jones (ABRSM)